

Chapter

Your Destiny Awaits — Just Clear the Debris



Introduction: How Do You Attain What Is Already There?

Most of us think of spiritual progress as a journey of **acquiring** something new — more effort, more resolve, more repetition. Acharya Upendra Ji turns this idea on its head. He says that what we need is already present within us; the only work is to remove the obstruction we ourselves have placed in the way.

To explain this, Acharya Ji gives two simple examples — Rishi Patanjali's example of the irrigation channel in a field, and the sun standing outside a closed curtain.

The Channel in the Field: Rishi Patanjali's Example

Acharya Ji begins with a well-known example from the Patanjali Yoga Darshan:

"In the Patanjali Yoga Darshan, Rishi Patanjali gives the example of a canal. There is a field. A path for water has been made in the field, and water is coming through it. The tap has been left on continuously — so will the water reach the whole field or not?"

But the problem is that something has got stuck along the way:

"But right at the start, at one spot, debris has come into its path — we call it a **roda** — debris or a stone has come in. So now what should be done? The water doesn't go further, does it? So should the tap be opened harder, or should just that debris be removed?"

In the Yoga Sutras, this very example appears in the following sutra, which uses the simile of the farmer (**kshetrika**):

**nimittam aprayojakaṁ prakṛtīnām varaṇa-
bhedaś tu tataḥ kṣetrikavat**

"Incidental causes do not set nature in motion; they only pierce the covering (the obstruction) — just as a farmer breaks the embankment of a field and the water flows on by itself."

— Patanjali Yoga Sutra 4.3

Acharya Ji's answer is clear:

"So just removing the debris is enough. The water was already present; the path was already present. The debris was the problem. Is there any need to release the water harder? Or any need to make the canal bigger? No."

There is no need to increase the water or widen the channel — only to remove the obstruction.

Not Repeating the Goal, but Removing the Obstacle

Acharya Ji applies the same principle to the seeker's life goal. "Nar se Narayan" — the journey from human to divine — is not fulfilled by repeating it again and again:

"'Nar se Narayan' — there is no need to be reminded of this goal ten times. Are you understanding? There is no need to repeat the goal of 'Nar se Narayan' a thousand times; 'I have to do something for the nation, have to do, have to do' — not this. It is already present within you."

He then explains the meaning of each part of the channel example:

- **The water** — **tattvajnana**, the knowledge of the ultimate truth, which is already present
- **The channel** — your destiny, the script of your life
- **The debris** — **maya**, illusion, which you yourself have put in the way

"That water, you see — that was **tattvajnana**; it is present just as it was. That was the channel — it was like your destiny, all of that was the script of your life. In knowledge, it was just like that. You have put the debris of **maya** in between."

And what is this debris? Acharya Ji names it:

"Only that curtain of **maya** has to be removed — 'I want money, only money; I want desires, desires, desires' — all that 'I, I', selfishness — the only work is to remove that. Otherwise, within, everything is Brahman."

Desire, selfishness and the ego of "I, I" — this is the stone blocking the flow of destiny.

The Sun Standing Outside the Curtain

The second example is of a curtain in a house. It is not dark because there is no sun:

"The sun is already present outside; you don't have to bring the sun separately. You put up a curtain, that is why there is darkness in your house."

Acharya Ji says this in a very affectionate way — the sun forces itself on no one:

"And Sun — meaning that sun — is a very decent person. He won't forcibly come into your house. He will say, 'You have closed the curtain, haven't you? I won't come. I'll wait outside, I'll fall up to the curtain, I won't come into the house. You don't wish it, so I won't come.'"

"'As much as you open, that much I will come inside. I am already present.'"

What this sun symbolizes, Acharya Ji explains himself:

"This sun is a symbol of the **Brahma-bhava**, the **Atma-bhava** within you. It is already there, full of light. It shines according to how much of a curtain of **jada buddhi** you have put up."

"You don't have to light the sun with a matchbox, don't have to strike a matchstick — nothing; it is within, already. The only work is to remove the debris."

The light of the Self shines forth only as much as we draw back the curtain. Here **jada buddhi** means the gross, undiscerning intellect that takes only the material to be real.

Three Kinds of Intellect, Three Kinds of Behaviour

Now the question arises — what should the seeker's attitude be? Acharya Ji answers through the three **gunas** — **sattva**, **rajas** and **tamas**.

The Sattvic Intellect: A Prayer to Remove Obstacles

"The sattvic intellect says, 'May all this debris not enter me. O Ganapati, may all those obstacles go away; I don't want obstacles.' And which obstacles? All these obstacles — understood?"

Here the meaning of the prayer to Ganapati — the remover of obstacles — changes: the obstacle is that very debris — desire, selfishness and ego.

The Rajasic Intellect: Asking for More Debris

"The rajasic person asks for even more obstacles — a little more money, a little more honour, a little more respect. So he talks of increasing the debris a little more."

What he asks for, thinking it is his progress, becomes a further obstruction in his own flow.

The Tamasic Intellect: Debris in Others' Channels Too

The tamasic person goes even further:

"He thinks of going to someone else's channel too and leaving debris there. He increases his own anyway, and goes and puts it in others' as well. Sometimes he even attempts to shut the tap — he won't be able to shut it, but he attempts it."

"On the contrary, he takes **dharmā** to be **adharma** and **adharma** to be **dharmā**. He doesn't remove the debris; he doubles it, and tries to shut the tap."

The Guru's Opponents and Duryodhana

Acharya Ji explains that this same tamasic tendency also shows itself as opposition to the Guru:

"They go against the Guru — there are such people, aren't there, against the Guru? Otherwise such an enemy side would never appear in the Guru's life story."

"These extreme tamasic ones — a Duryodhana is needed, isn't he?"

Just as Duryodhana stood against Shri Krishna in the Mahabharata, every Guru's life story has an opposing side — people who neither remove their own debris nor let others move towards **dharma**.

Summary: Key Teachings

- 1** What you need is already there. The water of **tattvajnana**, the channel of destiny and the sun of the Self — all are already present.
- 2** The work of **sadhana** is not adding but removing. Neither open the tap harder nor widen the channel — just remove the debris.
- 3** The debris is **maya**. "I want money, I want desires", "I, I" and selfishness — this is the stone in the way.
- 4** A goal is not fulfilled by rote. There is no need to repeat "Nar se Narayan" a thousand times; it is already within.

- 5 **The sun does not force its way in.** As much as you open the curtain, that much light of the Self will come in.
- 6 **The sattvic prays for obstacles to be removed, the rajasic asks for more debris, the tamasic blocks others' flow too — and takes dharma for adharma and adharma for dharma.**

"It is within, already. The only work is to remove the debris."